

GLOBAL CARBON BUDGET 2025 · OUR WORLD IN DATA

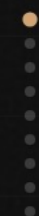
Global CO₂ Emissions

Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

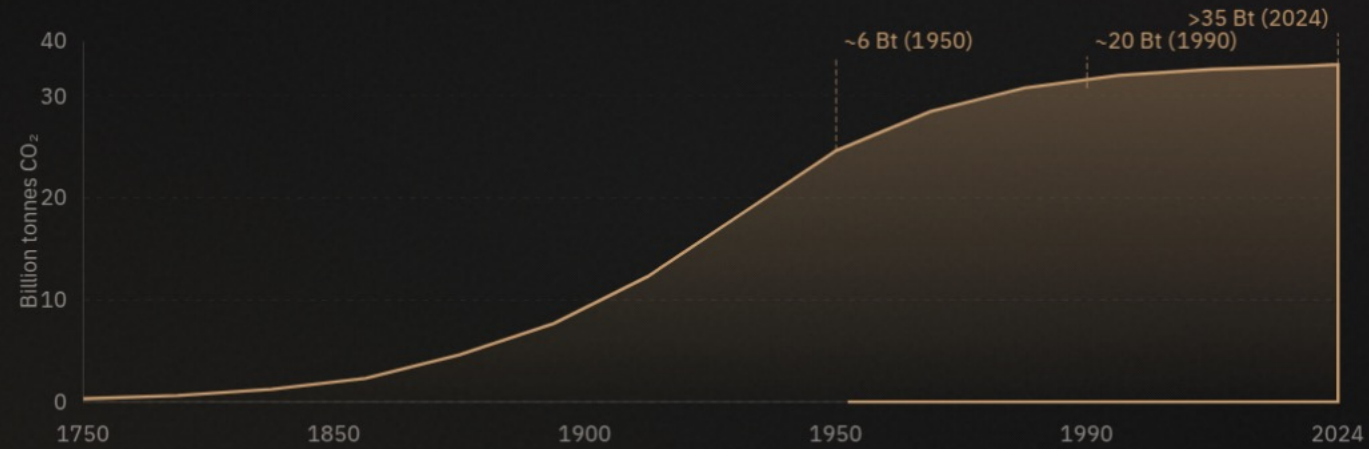
Fossil fuels & industry · 1750–2024

For policy analysts, climate negotiators & sustainability researchers

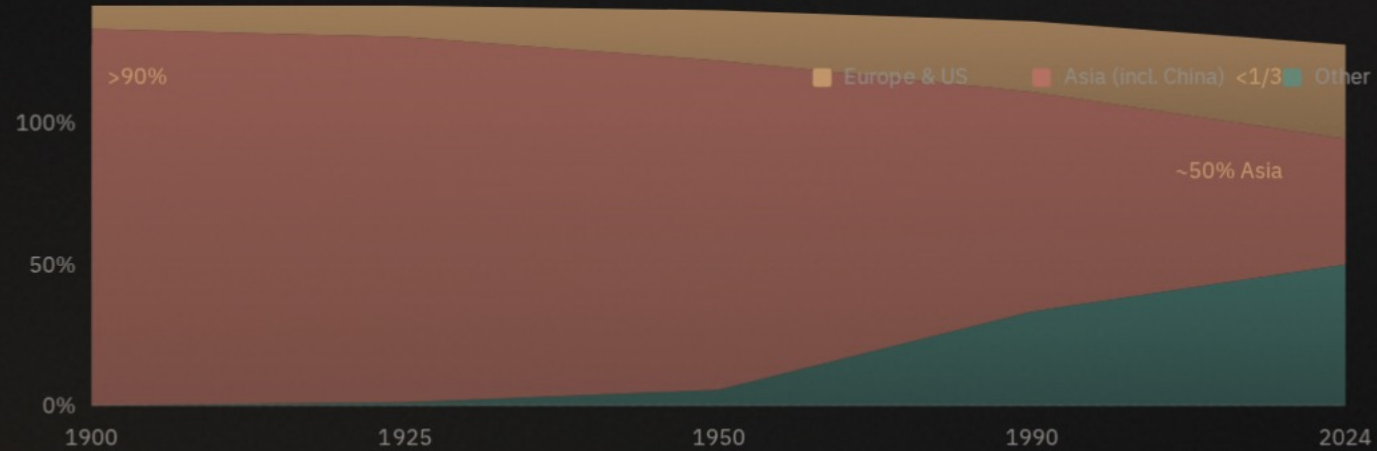
Data: Global Carbon Budget (2025) via Our World in Data · Authors: Hannah Ritchie & Max Roser



Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today



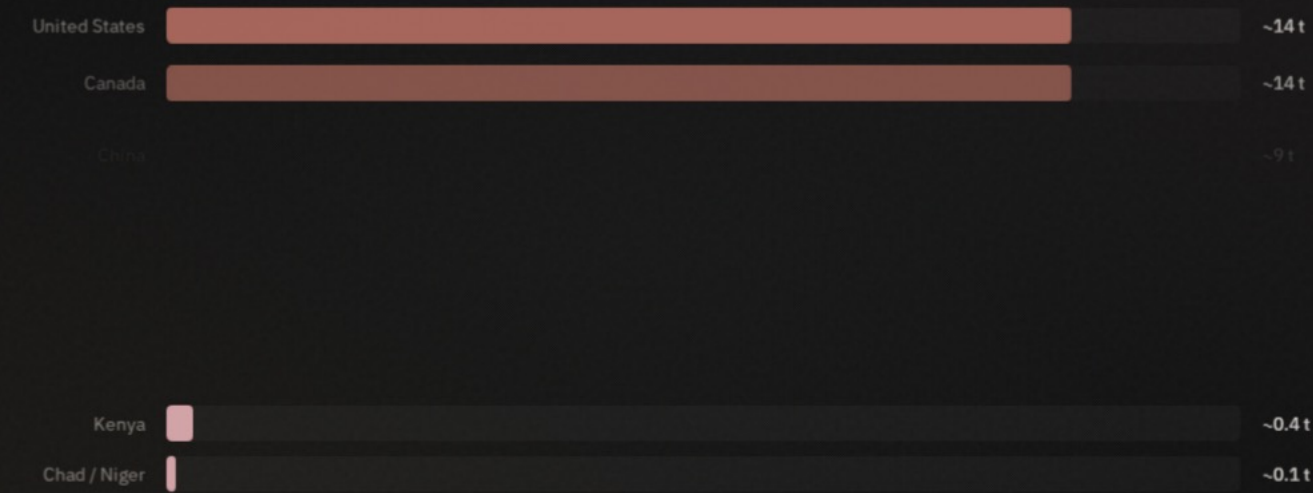
Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today



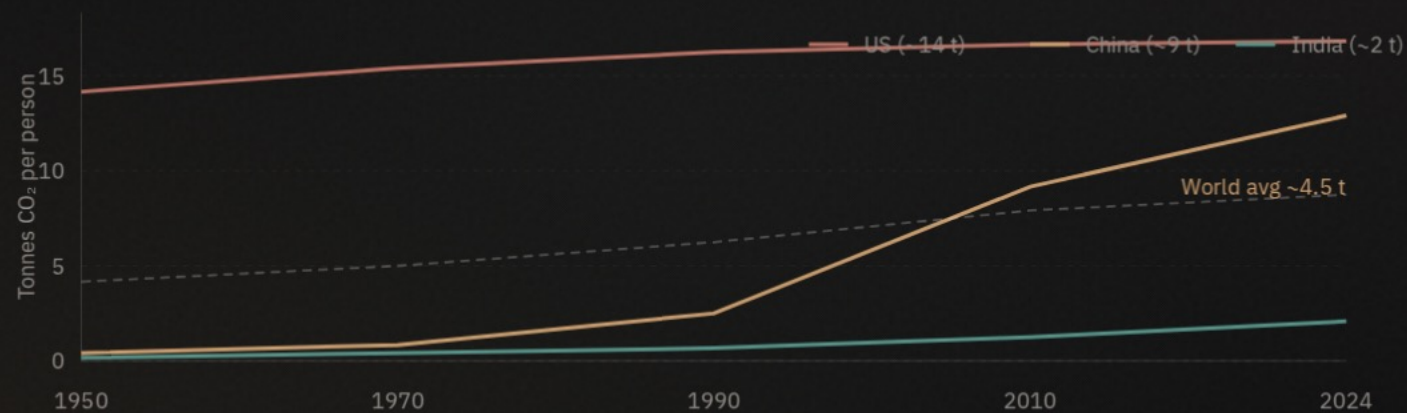
China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂



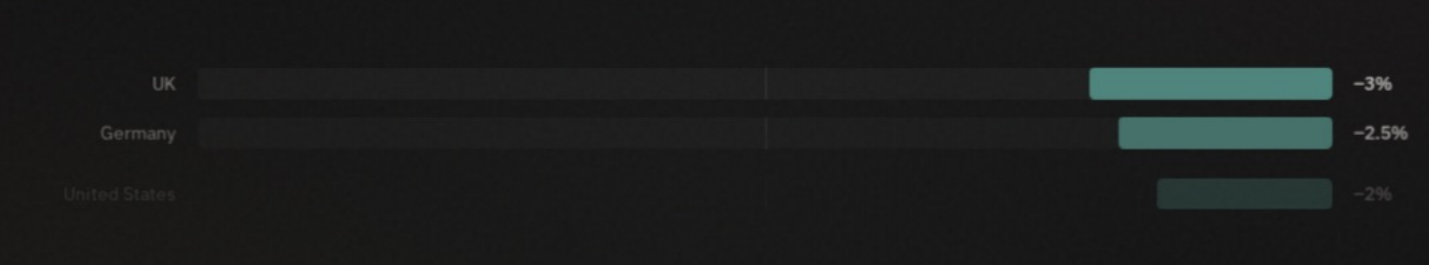
Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada



Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US
vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India



2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa Grew



Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US



Nuclear & renewables matter. France, the UK, and Portugal have much lower per capita emissions than Germany, the Netherlands, or the US.

Similar prosperity, very different footprints. A higher share of electricity from nuclear and renewable sources — rather than fossil fuels — drives the gap.

CONCLUSION

Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

- 1 **No peak yet.** Global CO₂ emissions from fossil fuels exceed 35 billion tonnes per year and have not yet peaked, despite slowing growth.
- 2 **China is the largest annual emitter** (~31%) but per capita emissions (~9 t) remain well below the US (~14 t).
- 3 **Historical responsibility is dominated by Europe and the US** — they accounted for >90% of emissions in 1900.